

# PHASE 1 SLATE (2008–2012): 8 FILMS

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Status: being built. Each film gets a full Film Dossier before it's locked.

| # | Title                                                          | Release date             | Owner                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Dossier                                                                                                         |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>Iron Man</b>                                                | Friday, May 2, 2008      | Marc-Anthony Bullock                                                                                                                                                                                          | <br><a href="#">complete</a> |
| 2 | <b>The Incredible Hulk</b>                                     | Friday, June 13, 2008    | Amond Baker                                                                                                                                                                                                   | <br>pending                  |
| 3 | <b>Thor</b>                                                    | Friday, May 1, 2009      | Esther Smilley                                                                                                             | <br>pending                  |
| 4 | <b>Ant-Man</b> (with the Wasp; final title set in the dossier) | Friday, November 6, 2009 | Tyler Chapman  (Elxa Bullock co-lead  ) | <br>pending                  |
| 5 | <b>Iron Man 2</b>                                              | Friday, May 7, 2010      | Marc-Anthony Bullock                                                                                                                                                                                          | <br>pending                  |
| 6 | <b>Captain America</b>                                         | Friday, July 22, 2011    | Tyrese Avery                                                                                                              | <br>pending                 |
| 7 | TBD                                                            |                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                 |
| 8 | TBD                                                            |                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                 |

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## FILM #1: IRON MAN (why it kicks everything off)

- **Character:** Tony Stark / Iron Man. First appearance: *Tales of Suspense* #39 (March 1963), Stan Lee, Larry Lieber, Don Heck and Jack Kirby.
- **Why Iron Man goes first, even though we own everyone:**
- **Thanos debuted in an Iron Man comic.** Jim Starlin introduced him in *Iron Man* #55 (Feb. 1973), so starting the Infinity Saga with Iron Man is comic-accurate at the very root.
- **He's the most grounded way in.** Iron Man runs on technology instead of magic, mutation or the cosmos, so a 2008 audience can believe it. Every later film makes the world a little bigger from there.
- **Tony pays for the Avengers.** On 616, Stark money builds the team and Stark's mansion becomes its home. The man who funds the Avengers should be the first one we meet.
- **S.H.I.E.L.D. fits naturally.** A defense contractor is exactly who Nick Fury would show up to see.
- **The underdog story matches the studio's.** It's a B-list hero from a studio that's never made a movie, starring an actor Hollywood wrote off. Tony, Marc-Anthony and Marvel all have something to prove.

- **Release date: Friday, May 2, 2008.** It's the first weekend of the summer season, a week ahead of *Speed Racer* (May 9) and three weeks ahead of *Indiana Jones and the Kingdom of the Crystal Skull* (May 22), which gives it room to hold on for several weekends.

## FILM #2: THE INCREDIBLE HULK

- **Character:** Bruce Banner / the Hulk. First appearance: *The Incredible Hulk #1* (May 1962), Stan Lee & Jack Kirby.
- **Why second:** he's a **founding Avenger**, and in *Avengers #1* **the Hulk is the reason the team forms** (Loki frames him). Audiences need to meet him before that. It also pairs naturally with Iron Man: both are science origins, and Tony's workshop TV already reported the gamma accident at Desert Base. It's a grounded fugitive thriller that widens the world one step.
- **Release date: Friday, June 13, 2008.** Six weeks after *Iron Man*, so Marvel has two films in theaters in one summer. It also avoids *Hancock* (July 2) and *The Dark Knight* (July 18).

## FILM #3: THOR

- **Character:** Thor Odinson. First appearance: *Journey into Mystery #83* (August 1962), Stan Lee, Larry Lieber & Jack Kirby.
- **Why third:** he's a **founding Avenger**, and **Loki, the villain who brings the Avengers together** in *Avengers #1*, comes from Thor's world. After two science films, Thor opens the door to **gods, magic and the Nine Realms**, and **the cosmos where Thanos lives**.
- **Release date: Friday, May 1, 2009.** It opens the 2009 summer season, the same slot *Iron Man* used, and comes a week ahead of *Star Trek* (May 8).

## FILM #4: ANT-MAN (with the Wasp)

- **Characters:** Dr. Hank Pym / Ant-Man, first appearing in *Tales to Astonish #27* (January 1962) and in costume in #35 (September 1962), and Janet van Dyne / the Wasp, first appearing in *Tales to Astonish #44* (June 1963). Stan Lee, Larry Lieber, H.E. Huebner & Jack Kirby.
- **Why fourth:** Ant-Man and the Wasp are **two of the five founding Avengers**, and **the Wasp names the team**. One film brings in both, as the comics did, and pays off the Pym journal from *Iron Man*. It's sci-fi adventure at impossible scale, a fresh genre after armor, monster and myth.
- **Release date: Friday, November 6, 2009.** It opens the holiday corridor with four more weeks of family audiences behind it.
-  **Casting note:** Tyler Chapman (Hank) and Eliza Blythe (Janet) have to be unlocked before this film goes into production, which means casting in 2008.

## FILM #5: IRON MAN 2

- **Character:** Tony Stark / Iron Man, the first sequel.
- **Release date: Friday, May 7, 2010.** The first Friday in May, two years after the original. It pays off the Mandarin's rings and "Next time, baby."

## FILM #6: CAPTAIN AMERICA

- **Character:** Steve Rogers / Captain America. First appearance: *Captain America Comics #1* (March 1941, cover-dated), Joe Simon & Jack Kirby. The Avengers find him in the ice in *Avengers #4* (March 1964).
- **Why sixth:**
- **Cap closes out the founding era the way the comics did.** In 616 he wasn't a founder. He joined in *Avengers #4* after the Avengers **found him frozen in the ice**. His film ends with Steve going into the ice, and *The Avengers* is where the team finds him.
- **It's the MCU's only period piece.** A WWII war epic from 1941 to 1945 gives the saga its history: **Project: Rebirth** and **Dr. Abraham Erskine, Bucky Barnes, the Red Skull, and Sgt. Nick Fury and his Howling Commandos** (616: they fought beside Cap). That's also where Samuel L. Jackson's Fury history comes from.
- **It sets up the Big Bad accurately to the comics.** The Red Skull's **Cosmic Cube** is the prize **Thanos went after first** in *Captain Marvel #27–33* (1973), before he ever went for the Gems. The Cube shows up in the Skull's hands in 1945, and Thanos will come for it.
- **Release date: Friday, July 22, 2011.** It's the heart of summer, three weeks after Independence Day, and clear of *Transformers: Dark of the Moon* (June 29). Paramount distributes both films and wouldn't put them head to head. It also comes a week after the final *Harry Potter* (July 15), once that film's opening surge has passed.

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### Phase 1 so far: the founders come first

By *Iron Man 2*, **four of the five founding Avengers** (Iron Man, Hulk, Thor, Ant-Man) plus the Wasp have been introduced. Slot #6 is **Captain America**, whom the Avengers find frozen in the ice as in 616. Slot #7 is still open, and **The Avengers** is Film #8 (2012).